good news is that it’s similar to minimal API filters in principle. The bad news is that it’s far more complicated!

Summary

- Web API action methods can return data directly or can use `ActionResult<T>` to generate an arbitrary response. If you return more than one type of result from an action method, the method signature must return `ActionResult<T>`.
- The data returned by a web API action is sometimes called an API model. It contains the data that will be serialized and send back to the client. This differs from view models and `PageModel`s, which contain both data and metadata about how to generate the response.
- Web APIs are associated with route templates by applying `RouteAttribute`s to your action methods. These give you complete control over the URLs that make up your application’s API.
- Route attributes applied to a controller combine with the attributes on action methods to form the final template. These are also combined with attributes on inherited base classes. You can use inherited attributes to reduce the amount of duplication in the attributes, such as where you’re using a common prefix on your routes.